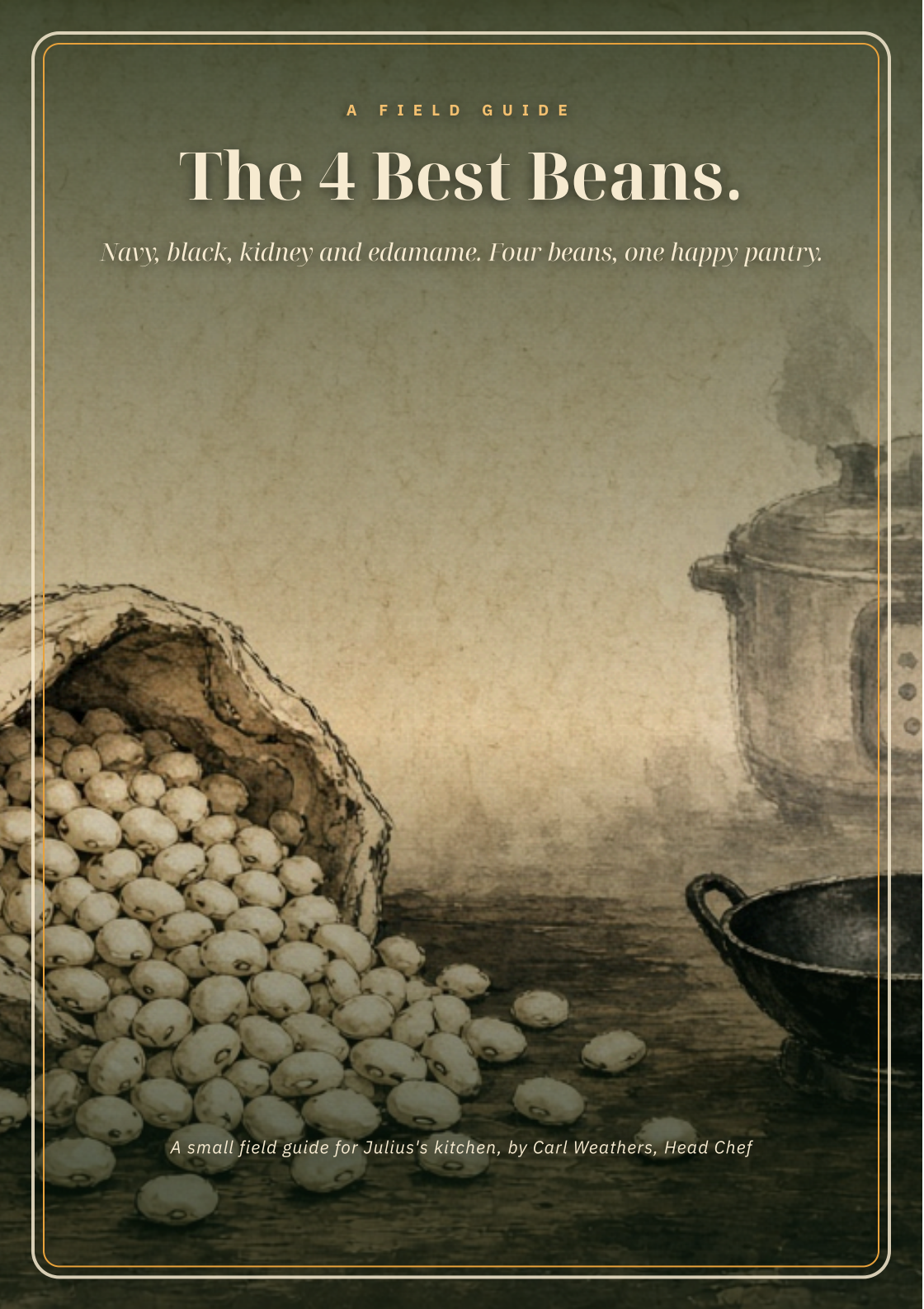
A FIELD GUIDE

The 4 Best Beans.

Navy, black, kidney and edamame. Four beans, one happy pantry.



A small field guide for Julius's kitchen, by Carl Weathers, Head Chef



A Word Before We Cook

Baby, a good pantry is like a good team. You don't need forty players, you need four you can count on. These are your four. They're cheap, they keep for months, and they'll carry protein and fiber into any stew you've got going.



One Family, One Cousin

- **Navy, black and kidney beans** are all one species, *Phaseolus vulgaris*, the common bean, first grown in the Americas thousands of years ago. Same plant, bred for different colors and sizes.
- **Edamame** is the young green soybean, *Glycine max*, picked before it dries. It's the cousin from Japan.

So three of your beans cook almost the same way, and the fourth is quick and fresh.



SECTION I · NAVY BEANS

Small, white, creamy. The stew bean.

Meet the Navy Bean

Small, oval and white, named for feeding the U.S. Navy. Cooks creamy and thickens a stew on its own.

Per 100 g cooked (USDA)	
Energy	140 kcal
Protein	8.2 g
Fiber	10.5 g
Starch (approx.)	15 g
Folate	140 µg
Iron	2.4 mg
Magnesium	53 mg
Potassium	389 mg



Buy, Store, Soak, Cook

- **Buy:** dry in bags or canned in brine. Look for whole, unbroken beans.
- **Store:** dry beans in a sealed jar, cool and dark, up to a year.
- **Soak:** cover with plenty of water overnight, drain and rinse.
- **Instant Pot:** soaked 7 to 8 minutes high pressure, unsoaked 25 to 30 minutes, then natural release 15 minutes.
- **Stovetop:** soaked, simmer 1 to 1.5 hours until creamy.



Navy Bean Recipes

Ham and Navy Bean Stew (Instant Pot). Soaked beans, onion, garlic, a ham hock and stock. 8 minutes high pressure, natural release. Mash a ladle of beans to thicken.

Crispy Navy Beans (air fryer). Cooked beans, patted very dry, tossed with oil and salt. 400°F (200°C) for 12 to 15 minutes, shake twice.



SECTION II · BLACK BEANS

Earthy, sweet, holds its shape.

Meet the Black Bean

Small and shiny black, the bean of Mexico, Cuba and Brazil. Keeps its shape and makes its own dark, rich broth.

Per 100 g cooked (USDA)	
Energy	132 kcal
Protein	8.9 g
Fiber	8.7 g
Starch (approx.)	15 g
Folate	149 µg
Iron	2.1 mg
Magnesium	70 mg
Potassium	355 mg



Buy, Store, Soak, Cook

- **Buy:** dry or canned in brine. Rinse canned beans to drop some salt.
- **Store:** dry in a sealed jar up to a year; cooked in the fridge 3 to 4 days.
- **Soak:** overnight in plenty of water, then drain.
- **Instant Pot:** soaked 8 to 10 minutes high pressure, unsoaked 25 to 30 minutes, natural release 15 minutes.
- **Stovetop:** soaked, simmer 1 to 1.5 hours.



Black Bean Recipes

Black Bean and Rice Bowl. Warm black beans with garlic and cumin over rice, a fried egg and chili on top.

Garlic Black Beans (wok). Hot oil, sliced garlic and onion, then cooked beans and a splash of soy sauce. Toss 2 to 3 minutes until glossy.



SECTION III · KIDNEY BEANS

Big, red, meaty. The chili bean.

Meet the Kidney Bean

Large and dark red, shaped like its name. Firm and meaty, made for chili and long stews.

Per 100 g cooked (USDA)	
Energy	127 kcal
Protein	8.7 g
Fiber	6.4 g
Starch (approx.)	16 g
Folate	130 µg
Iron	2.9 mg
Magnesium	45 mg
Potassium	403 mg



The One Rule

Raw kidney beans carry a natural lectin that can make you very sick. Heat destroys it, but only real heat.

- **Dried kidney beans: boil hard for at least 10 minutes,** or pressure-cook them in the Instant Pot.
- **Never slow-cook them from raw.** A slow cooker isn't hot enough and can make it worse.
- Canned kidney beans are already cooked and safe.



Buy, Store, Soak, Cook

- **Buy:** dry or canned. Choose glossy, unbroken beans.
- **Store:** dry in a sealed jar up to a year.
- **Soak:** overnight, drain, rinse. Use fresh water to cook.
- **Instant Pot:** soaked 10 to 12 minutes high pressure, unsoaked 30 to 35 minutes, natural release 15 to 20 minutes.
- **Stovetop:** soaked, a hard boil for 10 minutes, then simmer 1 to 1.5 hours.



Kidney Bean Recipes

Beef and Kidney Bean Chili (Instant Pot). Brown ground beef and onion on Sauté. Add soaked beans, tomatoes, chili powder, cumin and stock. 12 minutes high pressure, natural release.

Red Beans and Rice. Cooked kidney beans simmered with onion, garlic and smoked sausage until creamy. Over rice.



SECTION IV · EDAMAME

Young, green, fast. The snack bean.

Meet Edamame

Young soybeans, picked green in the pod. Sweet, nutty and done in minutes. The protein champion of your four.

Per 100 g cooked (USDA)	
Energy	121 kcal
Protein	11.9 g
Fiber	5.2 g
Starch (approx.)	1.5 g
Folate	311 µg
Iron	2.3 mg
Magnesium	64 mg
Potassium	436 mg



Buy, Store, Cook

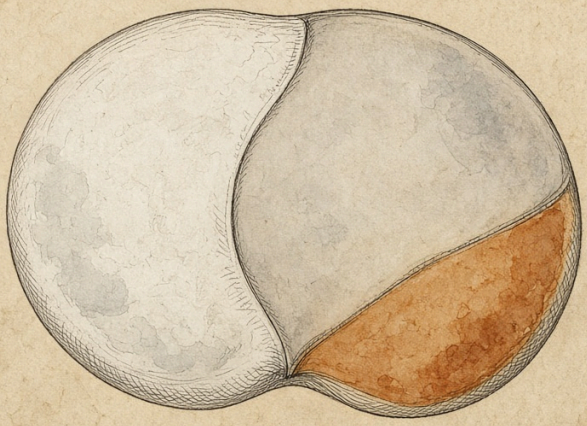
- **Buy:** frozen, in pods or shelled. Bright green, no freezer burn.
- **Store:** in the deep freezer; no soaking ever needed.
- **Boil:** straight from frozen into salted boiling water, 3 to 5 minutes.
- **Steam (Instant Pot):** 1 cup water, basket, 1 minute high pressure, quick release.
- **Air fryer:** 400°F (200°C) for 10 to 12 minutes, shake halfway.



Edamame Recipes

Salted Edamame. Boil in pods 4 minutes, drain, flaky salt. Done.

Garlic Chili Edamame (wok). Hot oil, garlic and chili flakes, boiled pods in, a splash of soy sauce. Toss 1 to 2 minutes.



The Four Side by Side

Per 100 g cooked (USDA FoodData Central):

	Navy	Black	Kidney	Edamame
kcal	140	132	127	121
Protein g	8.2	8.9	8.7	11.9
Fiber g	10.5	8.7	6.4	5.2
Starch g	15	15	16	1.5
Folate µg	140	149	130	311
Iron mg	2.4	2.1	2.9	2.3
Magnesium mg	53	70	45	64
Potassium mg	389	355	403	436

Navy wins fiber, edamame wins protein and folate, kidney wins iron, black wins magnesium.



The Deep Freezer Batch

1. Cook a full pot of one bean in the Instant Pot.
2. Let it cool in its broth.
3. Portion into flat freezer bags with a little broth, about 1.5 cups each (the size of one can).
4. Freeze flat, then stand them up like files. Label bean and date.
5. Keeps about 6 months. Thaw in the fridge overnight, or drop frozen straight into a hot stew.



Pairings

- **Navy:** ham, chicken, potato, rosemary, garlic, greens like bok choy.
- **Black:** rice, eggs, cumin, lime, chili, pork.
- **Kidney:** ground beef, tomato, onion, chili powder, smoked sausage.
- **Edamame:** sea salt, garlic, soy sauce, sesame, rice, broccoli.



Honest Evidence Note

Strong evidence: beans are cheap protein, fiber, folate and potassium, and diets rich in them are linked with better heart health and blood sugar. Moderate evidence: soaking and rinsing can ease gas for some people. Weaker: big claims about any single bean curing anything. Eat them because they're good food, baby.



What It Costs Julius

- Navy beans, dry 1 kg (Lazada): ฿133.5/kg.
- Navy beans sampler 4 kg, dry (Lazada): ฿716.0, about ฿179.0/kg.
- Organic black + navy beans, 1 kg each, dry (Lazada): ฿346.0.
- Cirio white beans in brine, 380 g (Freshket): ฿69.0.
- Fiamma black beans in brine, 400 g (Freshket): ฿73.0.
- Organic black beans, Manfuso 400 g (Paleo Robbie): ฿95.2.

Source: Julius's own price list. Dry beans cost far less per serving than cans.



Back Cover

Four beans. One pot. A freezer full of good days. Now go get that stew going.

Sources

- USDA FoodData Central: beans, navy, black, kidney (red), mature seeds, cooked, boiled; edamame, frozen, prepared.
- FDA Bad Bug Book: phytohaemagglutinin in raw kidney beans.